

Week 9 Study Guide

Diagnosis by Inquiry (continued: Limbs through Children's Symptoms) & Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — 聞診 (Wén Zhén)

Lecture 9 (Final Lecture) · Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

How to use this guide: Part I continues the Inquiry framework (Questions 8–16). Part II covers the second Pillar, Hearing & Smelling. Read once for the framework, then drill the tables — every finding-to-pattern mapping is in a table. Pair with the Cram Sheet the night before class or the Final.

Source note: Built from Prof. Schrier's Week 9 lecture transcript (the final class session, continuing Inquiry from Week 8 through Hearing & Smelling) and cross-checked line-by-line against the Inquiry slide deck (slides 661–730) and the Hearing & Smelling slide deck (slides 731–781). Dream-symbolism material is flagged separately as not tested, per Prof. Schrier's own slide.

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

PART I · Framework — Today's 16 Questions (Continued)

Week 9 is Prof. Schrier's final lecture and continues the 16-question Inquiry framework introduced in Week 7/8, picking up at Question 8. It then moves into the second Pillar of diagnosis: Hearing & Smelling.

#	Question Topic	Covered
1–7	Pain, Food/Taste, Stools/Urine, Thirst/Drink, Energy, Head/Face/Body, Chest/Abdomen	Weeks 7–8
8	Limbs	Week 9
9	Sleep	Week 9
10	Sweating	Week 9
11	Ears and Eyes	Week 9
12	Feeling of Cold, Feeling of Heat and Fever	Week 9
13	Emotional Symptoms	Week 9
14	Sexual Symptoms	Week 9
15	Special Questions Regarding Women's Health	Week 9
16	Special Questions Regarding Children's Health	Week 9

Quick Recall: Week 9 = Questions 8–16, then Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling (聞診). This is the last lecture before the Final.

1 · Limbs (Question 8)

Weakness & Numbness of Limbs

Presentation	Pattern
Tingling sensation (more often)	Blood deficiency
Numbness, often unilateral	Wind or Wind-Phlegm
Feeling of heaviness and/or swelling	Dampness
With pain	Qi or Blood Stagnation

Quick Recall: tingling=Blood deficiency; unilateral numbness=Wind/Wind-Phlegm; heavy/swollen=Damp; painful=Qi/Blood stagnation.

Generalized Joint Pain (often Wind, but can combine with Cold, Dampness, Heat)

Presentation	Pathogenic Factor
Pain that wanders joint to joint; sore and aching	Wind
Severe, fixed pain, worse with cold	Cold
Heaviness and aching, possible swelling and numbness in joints/limbs	Dampness
Pain with redness, swelling, and heaviness	Damp-Heat (redness=Heat, heaviness=Damp)

Atrophy / Flaccidity & Tremor of Limbs

Presentation	Pattern
Atrophy/Flaccidity — beginning stages	Stomach and Spleen-Qi deficiency
Atrophy/Flaccidity — later stages	Deficiency of Yin of the Liver and Kidneys, or deficiency of Yang of the Spleen and Kidneys
Tremors (always indicates Liver-Wind)	Can be excess or deficiency type Wind

Heads Up — Tremors always point to Liver-Wind, but don't stop there — ask whether it's an excess-type or deficiency-type Wind (e.g. sudden violent tremor/seizure vs. a fine, chronic tremor from Blood/Yin deficiency not nourishing the sinews).

Cold Hands / Feet & Weak Knees

Presentation	Pattern
Cold hands	Yang deficiency, or Heart Blood deficiency
Cold hands with palpitations and dizziness	Heart Blood deficiency
Cold fingers and toes, especially the tips	Liver Qi stagnation (Liver Qi can't send Qi/Blood to the extremities)
Cold feet	Kidney-Yang deficiency, or Liver Qi stagnation
Cold feet, in women specifically	Liver Blood deficiency
Weak knees	Deficiency of the Kidneys, especially Kidney-Yang

Quick Recall: cold fingertips especially = Liver Qi stagnation (torso stays warm). Cold feet in women specifically leans Liver Blood deficiency.

Feeling of Heaviness

Usually due to Dampness; can combine with Heat or Cold. When Spleen-Qi deficiency is associated with Stomach-Qi deficiency, heaviness is frequently experienced in all four limbs, not just the legs — because Earth (Spleen/Stomach) governs the limbs generally.

2 · Sleep (Question 9)

Principle	Detail
Root of sleep	Sleep depends on the state of Blood and Yin, especially of the Heart and Liver. The Spleen can also influence sleep.
Anchoring	The Mind/Shen and Ethereal Soul/Hun must be anchored with sufficient Heart and Liver Blood for good sleep.
Age	Length of sleep needed varies by age and generally decreases across one's lifetime — highest in babies, lowest in the elderly.

Sleep — Core Patterns

Presentation	Pattern
Not being able to fall or stay asleep	Deficiency of Blood not anchoring Mind/Shen and/or Ethereal Soul/Hun (Empty Condition)
Very restless sleep, feeling of heat, agitation, excessive dreaming	Pathogenic factors agitating the Mind/Shen and/or Hun out of Blood (Full Condition)
Difficulty falling asleep	Blood deficiency — usually Heart, but can be Liver or Spleen
Waking up many times during the night	Yin deficiency with Empty Heat (Heart, Liver, or Kidneys)
Waking early and failing to fall back asleep	Gall Bladder deficiency

Insomnia — Organ Differentiation

Often due to disharmony of the Heart or Liver (Stomach, Spleen, Kidneys and Gall Bladder may also play a role). Liver = excessive dreaming (dreams are pictures/vision, a Liver function). Heart = restlessness.

Presentation	Pattern
Insomnia with anxiety, dream-disturbed sleep, other Qi/Blood-deficiency signs	Heart and Spleen Blood deficiency
Insomnia with difficulty falling asleep, dizziness, blurred vision	Liver Blood deficiency
Insomnia, waking frequently with excessive dreams, night sweating, palpitations	Heart and Kidney Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
Dream-disturbed sleep (isolated)	Liver-Fire or Heart-Fire
Restless sleep with excessive dreams	Retention of food

Quick Recall: trouble FALLING asleep leans Heart Blood deficiency. Excessive DREAMING leans Liver. WAKING repeatedly leans Yin deficiency with Empty Heat.

Heads Up — Dreams are background only. Prof. Schrier's slide explicitly states "Bonus Material on Sleep Will Not Be Tested On." The Nèijīng dream passages (Sù Wèn 17 & 80, Língshū 43 — e.g. abundant Yin qì → dreams of wading through water; depleted Liver qì → dreams of fragrant plants) and the Pò/Hun/Shen dream categories (mundane/symbolic/deep-consciousness) are classroom color and context, not exam material. Know that they exist; don't drill the specific dream-to-organ mappings.

3 · Sweating (Question 10)

Condition	Common Cause
Full Conditions	Heat, or Damp-Heat
Empty Conditions	Deficiency of Yang, or deficiency of Yin

Area of Sweating

Location	Pattern
Only on head	Heat in the Stomach, or Damp-Heat
Oily sweat on forehead	Collapse of Yang
Only on arms and legs	Stomach and Spleen deficiency
Only on hands	Lung-Qi or Heart-Qi deficiency
Whole body	Lung-Qi deficiency
Palms, soles, and chest	Yin deficiency (five-palm heat)

Timing, Illness Stage & Quality

Feature	Pattern
Sweating in daytime	Yang deficiency
Sweating at night	Yin deficiency (occasionally can also be Damp-Heat)
Profuse cold sweat during severe illness	Collapse of Yang
Oily sweat on forehead, like pearls, not flowing	Collapse of Yang — danger of imminent death
Oily-quality sweat	Severe Yang deficiency
Yellow-quality sweat	Damp-Heat

Quick Recall: Daytime sweat=Yang deficiency. Night sweat=Yin deficiency. Oily/pearl-like on the forehead in severe illness=Collapse of Yang, a critical sign.

4 · Ears and Eyes (Question 11)

Tinnitus

Feature	Pattern
Sudden onset	Full condition — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang rising, or Liver-Wind
Gradual onset	Empty condition — Kidney deficiency
Noise aggravated by pressing on the ears	Full condition
Noise alleviated by pressing on the ears	Empty condition
Loud, high-pitched, like a whistle or cicada	Liver-Yang, Liver-Fire, or Liver-Wind
Low-pitched, like rushing water	Kidney deficiency

Deafness

Onset	Pattern
Sudden onset	Full condition — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang rising, or Liver-Wind
Gradual onset	Empty condition — deficiency of Kidneys, Heart-Blood, or Qi of the Upper Burner

Quick Recall: sudden tinnitus/deafness=Full-Liver pattern; gradual=Empty-Kidney (or Heart-Blood/Upper Burner Qi for deafness specifically). Pressure test: worse with pressure=Full, better with pressure=Empty.

Eyes

Presentation	Pattern
Eye pain, swelling, redness	Invasion of Wind-Heat, or Liver-Fire
Feeling of pressure in the eyes	Kidney-Yin deficiency
Blurred vision with floaters	Liver-Blood, Liver-Yin, or Kidney-Yin deficiency
Blurred vision with photophobia	Liver-Blood deficiency, or Liver-Yang rising
Dry eyes	Liver and/or Kidney-Yin deficiency

5 · Feeling of Cold, Feeling of Heat and Fever (Question 12)

Interior vs. Exterior Conditions — Framework

Condition Type	Component
Interior conditions	Feeling of cold
	Feeling of heat
Exterior conditions	Aversion to cold & "fever" (simultaneous)
	Feeling of heat in diseases of exterior origin
	Alternating feeling of cold and heat

Aversion to Cold

Means the patient feels **subjectively** cold — ranging from very mild to a strong cold feeling with shivering. Due to invasion of Wind: Wind obstructs the Cou Li (space between skin and muscles) where Wei Qi circulates; Wei Qi normally warms the muscles, so when obstructed the patient feels cold.

Fever

Does not necessarily indicate a raised temperature — it means the patient's body feels hot **on palpation** (objective). The intensity of "fever" relates to the struggle between Zheng Qi (Upright Qi) and the External Pathogenic Factor (EPF) — NOT whether the pathogen is Wind-Cold or Wind-Heat.

Zheng Qi vs. Pathogenic Factor	Fever Intensity
Both strong	High "fever"
Both weak	Low "fever"
One strong, one weak (either direction)	Medium "fever"

Heads Up — This is a classic trap: fever intensity is about the STRUGGLE (Zheng Qi vs. pathogen), not about whether the invading pathogen is Wind-Cold or Wind-Heat. Don't conflate fever severity with pathogen type.

Simultaneous Aversion to Cold & "Fever"

The key sign of an invasion of an exterior pathogenic factor. Corresponds to Wind-Cold at the Tai Yang stage (BL/SI) of the Six Stages, and the Wei/Defensive Level of the Four Levels.

Feeling of Heat in Diseases of Exterior Origin

A **subjective** feeling of heat indicates the pathogenic factor has now entered the Interior level. The patient has both a subjective feeling of heat AND their body is objectively emanating heat — this may or may not include an actual fever.

Alternating Feeling of Cold and Heat

The feeling of heat here is subjective. Indicates the pathogenic factor is in the Shao Yang stage (GB/TH) per Six-Stage/Channel Pattern Identification — i.e. Gall Bladder Heat in the Qi Level per Four-Level Pattern Identification.

Feeling of Cold — By Location

Location	Pattern
Cold limbs and abdomen	Spleen–Yang / Stomach–Yang deficiency
Cold hands and feet, especially the fingers	Liver Qi stagnation
Cold hands and chest	Heart–Blood deficiency, or Yang deficiency
Cold feet	Kidney–Yang deficiency, or Liver Qi stagnation
Cold legs, knees, feet, and back	Kidney–Yang deficiency

Feeling of Heat — By Timing

Timing	Pattern
Heat in the afternoon or evening	Empty–Heat
Low-grade fever, worse in the afternoon or only in the afternoon	Yin deficiency
Constant low-grade temperature	Damp–Heat (dampness obstructs full venting of the heat)
Fever in the middle of the night	Yin deficiency

Quick Recall: afternoon/evening heat pattern → Yin deficiency (Empty–Heat). Constant low-grade, doesn't fully resolve with sweating → Damp–Heat.

6 · Emotional Symptoms (Question 13)

Emotions are related to the Internal Causes of Disease and play an important role in etiology and clinical manifestations. The emotional state of the patient reflects the state of one's Mind and Spirit. The Heart is the only organ that "knows" what an emotion is (it houses the Shen/ consciousness) — every other organ is affected by emotion without being conscious of it. This is why emotional distress often still shows a red tip on the tongue (Heart).

Depression

Presentation	Pattern (Empty)
Insomnia, palpitations, tiredness, weak limbs, loose stools	Spleen and Heart–Blood deficiency
Palpitations, cold hands	Heart–Yang deficiency
Lack of sense of direction, sadness	Liver–Blood deficiency
Anxiety, night sweating, palpitations, red tongue without coating	Kidney and Heart–Yin deficiency with Empty–Heat
Lack of motivation/willpower, feeling cold, weak knees, frequent urination	Kidney–Yang deficiency

Presentation	Pattern (Full)
Moodiness, irritability	Liver–Qi stagnation
Irritability with red tongue	Stagnant Liver–Qi turning into Heat
Moodiness, irritability, feeling of a lump in the throat	Liver–Qi stagnation with Qi–Phlegm (Plum–Pit Qi)
Palpitations, anxiety, agitation, expectoration of phlegm, swollen tongue	Phlegm–Fire harassing the Mind
Palpitation, agitation, purple tongue (entire or chest area)	Heart–Blood stasis

Anxiety

Presentation	Pattern (Empty)
With insomnia, palpitations	Heart–Blood deficiency
Worse in the evening, palpitations, night sweating	Heart–Yin deficiency
With depression, insomnia, blurred vision	Liver–Blood deficiency
With depression, insomnia, tongue without coating	Liver–Yin deficiency
Worse in the evening, lack of willpower, dizziness, tinnitus	Kidney–Yin deficiency
With insomnia, palpitations, timidity	Heart and Gall Bladder Qi deficiency

Presentation	Pattern (Full)
Anxiety, depression, irritability, hypochondrial distention	Liver-Qi stagnation
Anxiety, headache (esp. temples), tinnitus, deafness, blurred vision, dizziness	Liver-Yang rising
Irritability, outbursts of anger, temporal headache, dizziness, red face/eyes, thirst, bitter taste, dark-yellow urine, epistaxis, Full Wiry Rapid pulse	Liver-Fire
Severe anxiety, palpitations, thirst, mouth/tongue ulcers, mental restlessness, agitation, feeling of heat, red face, dark urine or blood in urine, red tongue with coating	Heart-Fire
Severe anxiety, palpitations, stabbing/pricking chest pain radiating to inner left arm or shoulder, purple tongue	Heart-Blood stasis
Severe anxiety, palpitations, manic behavior, mental confusion, swollen tongue	Phlegm-Fire harassing the Mind

Heads Up — "Severe anxiety, palpitations, stabbing/pricking pain in the chest radiating to the inner left arm or shoulder" is the TCM description of what Western medicine would call a heart attack (Heart-Blood stasis). Know this cross-reference — it's a favorite way to test pattern recognition against a real clinical picture.

Presentation	Pattern (Full/Empty)
Palpitations, mental restlessness, insomnia, dream-disturbed sleep, anxiety worse in evening, poor memory, dizziness, tinnitus, low backache, heat in evening, dry throat at night, thirst with small sips, night sweating, five-palm heat, scanty dark urine	Kidney and Heart-Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
Palpitations, insomnia, dream-disturbed sleep, propensity to be startled, poor memory, anxiety worse in evening, mental restlessness, "uneasiness"/"fidgetiness," dry mouth and throat, night sweating, red tongue without coating (redder at tip, with red points), Floating-Empty pulse (esp. front left)	Heart-Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat

Irritability / Anger — Possible Roots

Root Mechanism
Qi stagnation
Blood stasis
Liver-Yang rising
Blood deficiency
Yin deficiency (with or without Empty-Heat)
Heat (including Damp-Heat)

Worry / Overthinking

Presentation	Pattern
Worry, slightly obsessive thinking, palpitations, slight depression, overthinking, loose stools, pale tongue, Empty pulse	Heart and Spleen Qi deficiency
Worry, depression, slight shortness of breath, slight cough, weak voice, pale tongue, Empty pulse	Lung-Qi deficiency
Worry, depression, palpitations, pale and thin tongue, Choppy or Fine pulse	Heart-Blood deficiency
Worry which increases after the period in women, pale tongue, blurred vision, Choppy or Fine pulse	Liver-Blood deficiency
Worry, insomnia, dream-disturbed sleep, poor memory, anxiety, propensity to be startled, mental restlessness, uneasiness, "feeling hot and bothered," Floating-Empty pulse (esp. front left), red tongue redder on tip, no coating	Heart-Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat

Sadness and Grief

Presentation	Pattern
With crying, depression, palpitations, breathlessness, dislike speaking, pale tongue, Empty pulse	Lung and Heart-Qi deficiency
With crying, mental confusion, blurred vision, aimlessness, pale tongue, Choppy or Fine pulse	Liver-Blood deficiency
With crying, depression, palpitations, dream-disturbed sleep, propensity to be startled, pale and thin tongue, Choppy or Fine pulse	Heart-Blood deficiency

Quick Recall: Depression/Anxiety/Worry/Grief all recur across the same short list of roots — Heart-Blood, Liver-Blood, Spleen-Qi, Lung-Qi, Kidney/Heart-Yin with Empty-Heat, Liver-Qi stagnation. Learn the ROOT mechanisms once; the specific emotion label matters less than the pattern underneath. · Cheng Xinnong CAM 4th ed.

7 · Sexual Symptoms (Question 14)

Men — Impotence

Presentation	Pattern
With feeling of cold, backache, abundant clear urination	Kidney-Yang deficiency
With dizziness, palpitations, choppy pulse	Heart-Blood deficiency
With palpitation, insomnia, dream-disturbed sleep, rapid overflowing pulse	Heart-Fire
Heaviness of the scrotum, urethral discharge, sticky yellow coating	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel

Men — Lack of Libido

Kidney-Yang or Qi deficiency · Spleen deficiency · Heart deficiency · Lung deficiency · Liver-Qi stagnation.

Men — Premature Ejaculation / Tiredness & Dizziness After Ejaculation

Presentation	Pattern
Premature ejaculation	Kidney-Qi not firm, Heart-Qi deficiency, or Heart-Blood deficiency
Tiredness and dizziness after ejaculation	Deficiency of the Kidneys

Heads Up — Younger men presenting with premature ejaculation are more often Heart-related (settling of the Heart, performance anxiety); older men are more often Kidney-related. Don't jump straight to "Kidney" for every case — consider age and the rest of the picture.

Women — Lack of Libido & Headache After Orgasm

Presentation	Pattern
Lack of libido or inability to reach orgasm	Kidney or Heart deficiency, Kidney-Yang deficiency
Excessive sexual desire	Liver or Heart-Fire, Empty-Heat from Kidney-Yin deficiency
Inability to reach an orgasm	Heart deficiency
Headache after orgasm	Rebellious Qi of the Penetrating Vessel (Chong Mai), or Heart-Fire

Heads Up — Sexual symptom patterns (lack of libido, excessive desire, inability to reach orgasm) are essentially the same mechanisms for men and women — Maciocia's text just happens to only list "excessive sexual desire" under the Women's section. Don't assume a pattern is sex-specific just because of where it's listed in the book.

8 · Special Questions: Women's Health (Question 15)

Menstruation — Cycle & Amount

Feature	Pattern
Periods always early	Blood-Heat, or Qi deficiency
Periods always late	Blood deficiency, or stagnation of Blood or Cold
Periods irregular (sometimes early, sometimes late)	Stagnation of Liver-Qi or Liver-Blood, or Spleen deficiency
Heavy loss of blood	Blood-Heat, or Qi deficiency
Scanty periods	Blood deficiency, or stagnation of Blood or Cold

Menstruation — Color, Quality & Pain

Feature	Pattern
Dark-red or bright-red blood	Blood-Heat
Pale blood	Blood deficiency
Purple or blackish blood	Stasis of Blood or Cold
Fresh-red blood	Empty-Heat from Yin deficiency
Congeaed blood with clots	Stasis of Blood or Cold
Watery blood	Blood or Yin deficiency
Turbid blood	Blood-Heat, or stagnation of Cold
Pain before the period	Stagnation of Qi or Blood
Pain during the period	Blood-Heat, or stagnation of Cold
Pain after the period	Blood deficiency

Quick Recall: dark/purple/clotted=stasis or Cold. Pale/watery=deficiency. Bright/fresh-red=Heat. Pain BEFORE=stagnation; pain AFTER=deficiency.

Leukorrhea (Vaginal Discharge)

Feature	Pattern
White	Cold, Spleen or Kidney-Yang deficiency, or exterior Cold-Damp
Yellow	Damp-Heat in the Lower Burner
Greenish-yellow	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel
Red and white	Damp-Heat
Yellow with pus and blood, after menopause	Toxic Damp-Heat in the uterus
Watery consistency	Cold-Damp
Thick/sticky consistency	Damp-Heat
Fishy smell	Damp-Cold
Leathery smell	Damp-Heat

Pregnancy & Childbirth

Presentation	Pattern
Infertility	Blood or Kidney Essence deficiency, Damp-Phlegm in the Lower Burner, or stasis/Cold in the uterus
Vomiting during pregnancy	Stomach and Chong Vessel disharmony
Miscarriage before 3 months	Blood or Essence deficiency
Miscarriage after 3 months	Liver-Blood stasis, or sinking of Spleen-Qi
Nausea and heavy bleeding after delivery	Exhaustion of the Chong (Penetrating) Vessel
Sweating and fever after delivery	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Post-natal depression	Heart-Blood deficiency (may also involve Pericardium, Spleen, or Liver — ask about the fuller picture)

Heads Up — The 3-month miscarriage cutoff is the differentiator: before 3 months think Blood/Essence deficiency (not enough to sustain); after 3 months think Liver-Blood stasis or Spleen-Qi sinking (a holding/stasis problem, not just insufficiency).

9 · Special Questions: Children's Health (Question 16)

The Spleen and Stomach are inherently weak in children as they fully develop — digestive symptoms dominate.

Presentation	Pattern
Abdominal pain	Cold in the Stomach and Intestines, or Qi stagnation
Vomiting of milk and colic in babies	Retention of food
Cough, wheezing, earache	Invasion of Wind attacking the Lungs
Chronic cough, wheezing with sticky sputum	Damp-Phlegm in the Lungs
Chronic earache	Damp-Heat in the Gall Bladder channel
Disturbed sleep with crying in babies	Retention of food, or Stomach-Heat
Disturbed sleep in older children	Liver-Fire, or Stomach-Heat
Skin rash, insomnia, change in character after immunizations	Latent Heat

Heads Up — Chronic earache in children is Damp-Heat in the **Gall Bladder** channel, not a generic "ear = Kidney" answer — know your deep channel pathways (the Gall Bladder channel has a well-documented ear pathway), not just the superficial map.

PART II · Framework: 聞診 (Wén Zhén) — The Second Pillar

Wén Zhén is the second of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切) and has two distinct components sharing one character (聞 — "to perceive with the ear/nose").

Component	Covers
Hearing	Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching — any sound emitted by the patient
Smelling	Body odor, and odor of bodily secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine/stools, vaginal discharge, intestinal gas)

Quick Recall: 聞診 = Hearing + Smelling, the 2nd of the Four Pillars (望聞問切).

10 · Voice & Zang-Fu Relationship

Organ	Role	Governs
Lung	Gateway of the voice; movement of qi helps create sounds	Production of sound
Kidney	Root of the voice; root of yuan qi, controls reception of qi	Volume of the voice
Spleen & Stomach	Acquired root of qi; influences vocalization	Strength of the voice

Quick Recall: Lung=production, Kidney=volume, Spleen/Stomach=strength.

11 · Voice — Basic Full/Empty Patterns

Vocalization	Pattern
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Weak and vague	Exterior wind-cold, or Dampness
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency
Excessive talking	Heat
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency

Quick Recall: Loud/excessive=Full/Heat. Weak/reluctant=Empty/Cold. Sudden loss=Wind-Heat invasion; gradual loss=Lung-Qi/Yin deficiency.

Abnormal Vocalizations: Hoarseness (by onset)

Onset / Quality	Pattern
Sudden onset, low pitch, raspy	Exterior syndrome
Chronic with gradual intensity	Blood stagnation
Hoarseness with plum-pit sensation & cough	Phlegm-Heat
Chronic onset, gradually increasing, worse in evening	Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency

Heads Up — "Worse in the evening" is the differentiator that flags Yin deficiency — don't just memorize "chronic," since Blood stagnation is also chronic but lacks the evening-worsening detail.

12 · Breathing & Respiration

Presentation	Pattern
Coarse, loud breathing sound	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing sound	Empty pattern
Deep breathing	Excess qi in the Heart and Lungs
Weak breathing	Deficiency of qi in Liver and Kidney
Rough respiration, rapid inhalation & slow exhalation	Heat, excess, exogenous condition
Faint respiration, slow inhalation and exhalation	Deficiency condition or chronic internal condition

Respiration — Excess/Heat vs. Empty/Cold

Feature	Excess / Heat	Empty / Cold
Sound of respiration	Loud	Low
Breath quality	Rough and distressed	Faint and slow
Onset	Acute	Relatively slow
Mechanism	Surplus of external contraction of evil qi, or Phlegm-Heat invading the Lung	Internal damage causing insufficient Zheng Qi and Kidney/Lung Qi vacuity

Quick Recall: Loud/rough/acute = Excess-Heat. Low/faint/slow-onset = Empty-Cold.

Panting (severe respiratory distress)

Rapid, irregular respiration, extreme to the point that the nostrils move, with uneven entrance and exit of breath, opening of the mouth, raising of the shoulders, and difficulty lying down.

Type	Presentation	Mechanism
Excess	Respiration irregular, chest full, sound loud and rough, exit of breath irregular and exhalation uneven	Disease/xie qi obstructing the Lung
Deficiency	Respiration irregular, breath timid, voice low, inhalation diminished and exhalation increased and rapid, breath not continuous, panting worse with movement	Kidney deficiency (unable to absorb qi) or Lung deficiency (unable to govern qi)

Abnormal Respiration Types

Type	Mechanism
Asthma	Lung qi's failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung qi fails to descend with phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung qi rises upward to the throat and obstructs air tract
Shortness of Breath	Lung qi deficiency, or Water Retention in the Chest (coughing up watery sputum)
Shortage of Qi	Lung qi obstructed, Lung qi deficiency, Zheng qi insufficient

13 · Cough, Sneezing & Reflexive Sounds

Cough — Ké Sòu 咳嗽

Due to the Lung not diffusing and down-bearing, Lung qi rising counterflow, and Phlegm and Qi flooding the airways.

Presentation	Pattern
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Sound without phlegm	"Unproductive cough"
Phlegm with sound	"Productive cough"

FAM310 Week 9 Study Guide · Sources: Prof. Schrier lecture transcript & slides (Inquiry deck 661–730, Hearing/Smelling deck 731–781) · Maciocia FCM 3rd ed. · Cheng Xinning CAM 4th ed.

Sneezing

Presentation	Pattern
Acute onset, constant loud sounds	Heat and/or excess condition
Chronic, frequent, soft in volume	Lung deficiency
Sudden sneezing in critical stage of chronic illness	Yang qi recovery
Sneezing due to external stimulation	Normal

14 · Vomiting, Belching & Hiccup

All three share the same root mechanism — Rebellious Stomach Qi — and differ only in what is expelled and how.

Symptom	Common Root	Differences
Vomiting	Rebellious ST Qi	Food, fluid or sputum flows up from the Stomach and out of the mouth with sound
Belching		Air or gas flows up from the stomach and makes sound passing through the throat
Hiccup		ST Qi's rebellion causes involuntary spasms of the diaphragm and makes a short sound

Symptom	Deficiency/Cold Presentation	Excess/Heat Presentation
Vomiting	Comes slowly, sound of retching relatively low, faint, and without force — frequently ST deficiency and Cold	Comes relatively suddenly, sound of retching relatively loud and forceful — frequently ST-Heat
Belching	Short and low sound — ST-Qi deficiency, or ST-Qi deficiency with Cold	Loud and long sound — retention of food, ST-Heat, or LV-Qi invading the Stomach
Hiccup	Quiet, low sound — often ST-Qi or ST-Yin deficiency	Loud sound — often LV-Qi invading the Stomach

Quick Recall: All three = Rebellious ST Qi. Loud/forceful=Excess-Heat or LV invading ST. Quiet/faint=ST deficiency (Qi, Yin, or Cold).

15 · Borborygmi, Yawning & Sighing

Borborygmi (gurgling sound in the intestines)

Sound	Pattern	Subtypes
Loud	Full pattern (usually with diarrhea or dysentery)	Cold-damp in MB, Phlegm-damp in MB, LR/SP disharmony, Damp-Heat in ST & Intestines
Low	Empty pattern	SP/KI yang deficiency, MB qi deficiency

Yawning

Presentation	Pattern
Frequent, loud, relieved after yawn, induced by emotional changes	Liver Qi Stagnation
Accompanied by chest pain, may occur after injury or chronic illness	Blood and Qi Stagnation
Infrequent, weak or no sound	Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency

Sighing

Generally indicates Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs, often from emotional problems.

Cause	Emotion / Mechanism
Liver involvement	Repressed anger or frustration
Lung involvement	Worry & sadness
Weak sound (alternate root)	Deficiency of Spleen and Heart, deriving from sadness, grief, or pensiveness

16 · Five Element Sounds — 五音 Wǔ Yīn

Voice quality/expression, paired to the Five Elements. Distinct topic from the Five (named) Odors in Section 19 — don't conflate the two lists.
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Element	Sound	Pinyin / Hanzi	Character of the Sound
Wood	Shouting	Hū 呼	Gives forcefulness to the voice; an indication of assertion. When one shouts they want to be heard and/or are asking, explicitly or implicitly, for changes to be made. Frequently louder at moments when the person isn't really needing to be particularly assertive.
Fire	Laughing	Xiào 笑	Occurs when expressing moments of joy. Doesn't necessarily mean an actual belly laugh — can include a "pre-laugh" without one emerging. Fire is a very yang Element, so just as laughter rises upwards and outwards, so does this sound.
Earth	Singing	Chàng 唱	May occur naturally when singing a lullaby with a child in arms, or soothing an anxious or distressed animal/person. Has increased variation in pitch — the voice goes up and down more frequently.
Metal	Weeping	— (no pinyin/ hanzi given on slide)	Consumes or dissolves qi. More of a non-verbal sound but based on an expressive, emotional quality. When speaking with a weep the person might easily begin to cry; other times there could be a choking back or a faltering in the words.
Water	Groaning	— (no pinyin/ hanzi given on slide)	Has little movement or modulation in its quality — a flatness, as if the more normal ups and downs of the voice have been squeezed or flattened out.

Quick Recall: Shout=Wood, Laugh=Fire, Sing=Earth, Weep=Metal, Groan=Water — same order as the standard Five Element cycle.

17 · The Six Healing Sounds — Liù Zì Jué

Sound	Organ	Effect
Xū 嘘	Liver	Removes heat, disperses blockages, brings brightness to the eyes
Hē 呵	Heart	Expels heat, makes qi descend, reduces fire in the heart
Hū 呼	Spleen	Drives out heat, strengthens the spleen in all four seasons
Sì 呬	Lung	Moderates stress, calms the qi, moistens the lungs
Chuī 吹	Kidney	Removes wind and cold, urges stagnant qi, brings tranquility to the kidneys
Xī 嘻	Triple Burner	Clears heat and restlessness, drives out strong emotional afflictions

Heads Up — Hū 呼 appears twice with two different meanings: the **Shouting** voice sound (Wood, Section 16) and the **Spleen** Healing Sound (this section). Same pinyin/hanzi, different context — know which table you're in before answering.

18 · Diagnosis by Smelling — Framework

Aspect	Tells the Practitioner
First: Odor of the patient's body itself	Can indicate not only the pattern of disharmony but also the patient's constitutional type
Second: Odor of certain bodily secretions	Used only to identify the nature of the pattern of disharmony

Rule	Indicates
Strong and/or foul, rotten, fetid, stinking smell	Heat or Excess
Absence of smell, or fishy smell	Cold or Deficient

Quick Recall: Generally, strong/foul = Heat. Absent/fishy = Cold. Applies across nearly every secretion below.

Body Odor

Odor	Pattern
Goatish odor	Wind, damp, heat accumulation
Foul, stinking (fox-like)	Epidemic infectious disease, or summer heat toxin
Foul, set in the armpit	Damp-heat accumulation

19 · The Five (Named) Odors

Heads Up — Unlike the Five Element Sounds (Section 16), these five odor-description slides do NOT explicitly label each smell with a Zang-Fu element. Also, the "Scorched" slide title uses the character xiào 笑 — the same hanzi as "Laughing" from Section 16. Classically the Fire-element scorched odor is jiāo 焦, a different character. This looks like a copy/paste label error on the lecture slide — confirm with Prof. Schrier rather than memorizing 笑 for "scorched," and don't assume the classical Wood/Fire/Earth/Metal/Water odor pairing (sour-scorched-fragrant-rank-putrid) maps 1:1 onto this list without confirming it in class.

Odor	Sensory Description
Rancid (Sōu 餿)	Associated with fat that is no longer fresh or slightly sour. Also related to the smell of newly-mown grass, but not pleasant. Effect on the inside of the nose is somewhat prickling and makes one wrinkle their nose.
Scorched	Resembles what someone would describe as the smell in life — e.g. burnt toast, clothes coming out of the tumble dryer, a shirt just scorched while ironing.
Fragrant (Xiāng 香)	Often thought of as a pleasing smell such as flowers, but this odor is the opposite and not as pleasing — more associated with a cloying, sickly sweet smell with a tendency to linger in the nostrils.
Rotten (Lǎn 爛)	Fills the inside of one's nose with tiny prickles and may make one clench the inside of their nose. Rotting meat is the best verbal description, or a trash can/garbage truck where many substances are decomposing.
Putrid (Fǔ 腐)	Described as the smell of rotting meat. Can describe the smell of water in a stagnant pond or the smell of stale urine. Has a sharp and aggressive quality, making one's nose clench up.

20 · Odor of Bodily Secretions

Breath

Odor	Pattern
Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Sour	Retention of food, Accumulation Disorder
Foul, pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen
Rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine
Fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung

Sweat

Related to Dampness because the fluids forming sweat come from the space between the skin and muscles, where Dampness often accumulates.

Odor	Pattern
Strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Putrid-smelling	Indicates a disease of the Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys

Sputum

Odor	Pattern
Strong-smelling, often smelling rotten	Heat in the Lungs, usually Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Without smell	Cold

Stool & Flatulence

Presentation	Pattern
Extremely stinky, foul odor, diarrhea with pus or blood	Damp-Heat in the Intestines
Sour and foul odor with indigestion	Food stagnation
Fishy odor with loose stools	Cold in Spleen/Stomach
Slight or odorless flatulence, aggravated by emotional stress	Liver qi stagnation
Flatulence smells rancid and rotten, like rotten eggs	Toxic Heat in the Large Intestines
Abnormal stool color but without odor, or frequent flatulence without strong odor	ST/LI qi deficiency

Urine

Presentation	Pattern
Frequent, urgent, painful, burning, turbid yellow with foul odor	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow urine	Heart fire pouring downward into Bladder
Clear, frequent, odorless or with a slightly fishy odor	Kidney deficiency
Odorless urinary incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney fire

Vaginal Discharge

Presentation	Pattern
Strong-smelling, leathery smell	Damp-Heat
Fishy smell	Damp-Cold
Strong-smelling lochia after childbirth	Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus

Odors of Nose, Ears, Eyes

Site	Presentation	Pattern
Nose	Yellow, sticky discharge with foul odor	Heat in Lung or Damp-Heat in SP & ST
Ears	Foul, fishy odor emanating from ears with turbid pus and discharge	Damp-Heat in the ear
Eyes	Red, swollen eyes with turbid tears accompanied by foul, fishy odor, or ulcerations around the eyes	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel

Quick Recall: Across nearly every secretion, foul/strong/rotten = Heat or Damp-Heat; fishy or odorless leans Cold or Deficiency – the general rule from Section 18 holds.

21 · Vocabulary Table

Character	Pinyin	English	Note
聞診	Wén Zhén	Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling	2nd of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切)
呼	Hū	Shout (voice sound)	Wood-element voice sound — forcefulness, assertion; ALSO the Spleen Healing Sound
笑	Xiào	Laugh (voice sound)	Fire-element voice sound — expression of joy; also mislabels the "Scorched" odor slide
唱	Chàng	Sing (voice sound)	Earth-element voice sound — soothing, wide pitch variation
咳嗽	Ké Sòu	Cough	Lung qi rising counterflow + Phlegm/Qi flooding the airways
嘘	Xū	"Xu" Healing Sound	Liver — removes heat, clears blockages, brightens the eyes
呵	Hē	"He" Healing Sound	Heart — expels heat, makes qi descend, reduces fire
呬	Sì	"Si" Healing Sound	Lung — moderates stress, calms qi, moistens the lungs
吹	Chuī	"Chui" Healing Sound	Kidney — removes wind-cold, urges stagnant qi
嘻	Xī	"Xi" Healing Sound	Triple Burner — clears heat/restlessness, emotional afflictions
餿	Sōu	Rancid odor	Fat no longer fresh / newly-mown grass, unpleasant
香	Xiāng	Fragrant odor	Cloying, sickly sweet — NOT actually pleasant in this context
爛	Làn	Rotten odor	Rotting meat / decomposing trash
腐	Fǔ	Putrid odor	Rotting meat / stagnant water smell

22 · Clinical Case — Apply It

Ms. Delgado, 29 years old, a competitive ballroom dancer — presents 3 days before a competition with cold, tingling fingertips that turn pale mid-routine, irritability she describes as "on edge," and a feeling of a lump in her throat she can't clear when she's stressed about choreography changes. She sighs frequently during warmups. Her periods have been irregular this season — sometimes early, sometimes 10 days late — with clotted, dark blood and cramping that eases once bleeding starts. Voice is otherwise normal volume; no cough or breath-odor complaints.

Working through it: Cold, tingling fingertips → **Liver-Qi stagnation** (Part I, Section 1 — Liver Qi can't send Qi/Blood to the extremities, tips especially). Irritability + lump in the throat she can't clear → **Liver-Qi stagnation with Qi-Phlegm (Plum-Pit Qi)** (Part I, Section 6). Frequent sighing → consistent with **Liver Qi stagnation** from repressed frustration (Part II, Section 15). Irregular periods (sometimes early, sometimes late) → **stagnation of Liver-Qi or Liver-Blood** (Part I, Section 8). Clotted, dark blood with pain that eases once bleeding starts → **stasis of Blood**, pain-before-period pattern pointing to **stagnation of Qi or Blood** (Part I, Section 8).

Working TCM pattern: Liver-Qi stagnation, affecting the extremities, throat (Plum-Pit Qi), and menstruation — a single unifying mechanism across four different intake categories.

Dance-medicine note: Cold, stagnant Liver-Qi at the fingertips is a real performance concern for a dancer relying on fine hand articulation (a hallmark of American Rhythm styling) — and pre-competition stress is a classic trigger for Liver-Qi stagnation to flare. This is exactly the kind of case where Inquiry findings across seemingly unrelated categories (limbs, throat, emotions, menstruation) converge on one root pattern.